

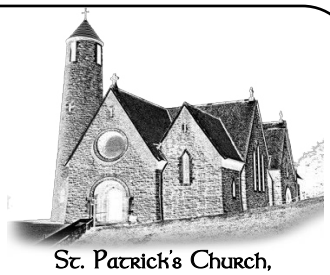
St. Agatha's Church, Clar

Tawnawilly Parish Newsletter

Sunday 25th October 2026
30th Sunday in Ordinary Time/A

Parish Website
www.tawnawillyparish.ie

Facebook
@tawnawillyparish



St. Patrick's Church, Donegal Town

Mass Times Intentions for this Week

Day	St. Agatha's	St. Patrick's	Intention	
Saturday 24th Oct		**6.00 pm**	Phonsie Mc Daid	1st Anniversary
Sunday 25th *30th Sunday in Ordinary Time/A*	**10.00 am**		Sean Martin Joseph & Isabelle Mc Ginty John Mc Coy & Paul Feeney Maeve Monaghan Kevin & Louise O'Callaghan Hugh Mc Menamin	Anniversaries
		11: 30 am	Paddy Mc Glynn Maurice Austin	Anniversaries
Monday 26th			**No Mass**	
Tuesday 27th	**10.00 am**		Intention	
Wednesday 28th		**10.00 am**	Jim & Bridget Keeney	Anniversaries
Thursday 29th	**10.00 am**		Intention	
Friday 30th		**10.00 am**	Intention	
Saturday 31st		**6.00 pm**	Cormick Ward	Anniversary
Sunday 1st Nov *All Saints/A*	**10.00 am**		Eamonn Feeley John Sweeney Mai & Joe Mundy Liam Mc Groarty Willie & Maeve Faulkner & Eugene Kilkenny	1st Anniversary Anniversaries
		11.30 am	Helen Mc Groary	Months Mind

We pray for the Anniversary of…
John Mc Coy and **Paul Feeney**, Glasgow whose anniversaries occurs at this time.

Eucharistic Adoration

Tuesday's St. Agatha's Church
Adoration 3pm – 6pm
Thursday's: St. Patrick's Church
2.00 pm – 8.00 pm
Confession
Upon request or after any Mass.

All Masses in both Churches are broadcast live on our parish website or on www.mcn live and follow the links.

Parish Priest
Fr. James Gillespie, P. P.
Parochial House, Upper Main St.,
Donegal Town, Co. Donegal
F94 D8X0
Phone: 074 97 21026
Email: ppdonegal@gmail.com

Parish Office
Parish Centre, Upper Main St.,
Donegal Town, Co. Donegal.
F94 EWR4
Phone: 074 97 21026 / 97 40461
stpatricksparishcentre@gmail.com
Opening Times:
Mon., Tues., Wed. & Friday
9: 00 am – 2: 00 pm

Parish Bookings
To book a baptism, wedding or to book the Parish Centre itself, please contact the Parish Office

Baptisms
Baptisms take place in St. Patrick's on the 1st & 3rd weekends and in St. Agatha's Church on the 2nd & 4th weekends of each month. Baptisms are held on Saturdays at 4: 00 pm or Sundays at 1: 00 pm. Baptismal Preparation course takes place in the Parish Centre on the last Tuesday of each month for all families requiring their child to be baptised.

Weddings
Please allow at least four months' notice for weddings in the parish. Please see our website for further information on parish weddings.

Parish Newsletter
Please submit items for the Newsletter to the parish office no later than 12 noon on Thursday's, by phone, email or dropping in a note.

Notices

The Children's Rosary 7pm - The month of Oct is dedicated to the holy Rosary which will be held in St. Patrick's Church every Wednesday. The children will learn how to meditate on the Rosary and learn about the Great Saints associated with the Rosary.

Cursillo Mass 25th October at 3pm
An open invitation is warmly extended to everyone to join Bishop Niall Coll for a Holy Mass in thanksgiving for Cursillo in St Mary's Church Stranorlar at 3pm on Sun 25th Oct. And afterwards to a gathering in the Parish Centre (Stranorlar). All are most welcome.

Scoil Aodh Rua agus Nuala
Is taking Enrolments for Junior Infants from 2nd Oct. 2026 to 20th Nov. 2026. Application forms are available from the school office by telephone on 0749722661 or email office@saran.ie
Forms also available to download from our school website www.saran.ie

St Francis' National School, Barnesmore, Co. Donegal - We are now enrolling pupils for school year 2027/2028
Phone: 074 9722109
Email: stfrancisns@gmail.com

Mass for People killed in Road Traffic Accidents - There will be a mass in Christ The King Church, Gortahork, for families who have lost someone or people in road accidents on **Sunday 15/11/2026 at 11.00 a.m**. send an email to tpcr1906@gmail.com to add their name to the prayer list **before Friday 30/10/2026.**

Eucharistic Adoration
Spending an hour in the presence of God in adoration is a wonderful way to deepen our faith. This involves
(a) knowing about God
(b) knowing God.
A good way to be mindful of this is that each time we bless ourselves we say the following prayer: In the Name of the Father who created us in his Image, in the Name of the Son who redeemed us with his precious blood, in the name of the Holy Spirit who sanctifies us and makes us children of God…

Community Employment Project
We have a vacancy on our local Community Employment project for a Caretaker at St. Patrick's Centre. If you are unemployed and interested in the position, please contact 087 7694024 flexible part-time hours.

Cleaning of St. Patrick's Church – on Monday 26th Oct at 7pm. If you have 1 hour free all help is greatly appreciated.

Nominations requested for Tawnawilly Parish Pastoral Council (PPC) The Parish Pastoral Council (PPC), which has been in place in our parish since 2023, is now renewing its membership and looking for new people to become involved. Some existing members will step down, while those remaining will continue in their role, offering experience and continuity. New members will be welcomed and will bring new ideas and perspectives. This process of renewal helps to keep the council representative of the parish community and responsive to the current needs of the parish. The role of the PPC is to work alongside the parish priest Fr. James, in addressing all aspects of the pastoral life of the parish including liturgy, formation, social activities and outreach. The PPC meet every four to six weeks from September to June each year. The council helps to identify the current and future needs of the parish and encourages people to become actively involved in the parish to support and strengthen our community of faith. If you wish to nominate someone who you feel would be suitable for this role, please put their name in the Parish Pastoral Council suggestion boxes at the back of St. Agatha's Church or St. Patrick's Church.
Thank you, Tawnawilly Parish Pastoral Council

The Raphoe Diocesan Society was founded in 1874. In Nov. of each year an Annual Mass for the Deceased Members of the Society is offered in a different parish. Annual RDS Mass for 2026 will be in St Columba's Church, Glenswilly Tues. 17th Nov. at 7.30pm
Celebrant: Most Rev Niall Coll, Bishop of Raphoe.
To enrol a person in the RDS contact your local priest or email:rds@raphoediocese.ie for more details. The enrolment fee is €15 per person living or deceased. All donations go towards the Clergy Retirement Fund. Each parish are to offer 4 masses during November (2 for deceased members and 2 for living members).

In Loving Memory "St. Agatha's Graveyard Clar Book Supplement, Inscriptions 2021-2024
This book will be on sale next weekend Saturday 31st and Sunday 1st November at all Masses. Price is €14 per copy.

NOVEMBER NOVENA FOR THE HOLY SOULS
The Novena for the Holy Souls will take place in the parish from Monday 2nd November and conclude on Thursday 12th. The Novena will be held in each church on the following days:
St. Agatha's: Mon. 2nd, Wed. 4th, Fri. 6th, Mon. 9th, and Wed. 11th.
St. Patrick's: Tues 3rd, Thurs 5th, Tues 10th and Thurs. 12th. **All the Masses for the Novena will take place at 7. 00pm**.
The November Envelopes for the list of the Holy souls will be made available during the week. Like last year, we again are asking families of parishioners who have died during the past year to bring in a picture of their recently deceased family member to either, St. Agatha's or St. Patrick's Church. These pictures will then be put on display during the Novena where we can remember and pray for them in a special way. As St Paul wrote to the Romans: "Nothing can separate us from the love of Christ". The pictures of those who have died, are pictures of people who are still our family members, parishioners, neighbours, brothers and sisters in the faith and part of all of us. Having their pictures displayed during the Novena will give us all, once again, an opportunity to pray in a special way for them and remember them. It is also a way for us as a parish to acknowledge the pain and hurt that their bereaved families have endured and to assure them of the consolation our prayer and our sympathy. Therefore, if you are a family member of a parishioner who has died recently, (since 1st November 2024) we are asking you, to bring in a framed photo of your loved one. We would need them by Sunday 1st November at the latest, so as to prepare the display in time for All Souls Day, Nov. 2nd. You can leave them in the Parish Office, or the sacristy of either church, with your contact details. The pictures will be returned to you after the Novena. Thank you.

CONFIRMATION & FIRST COMMUNION 2027
CONFIRMATION: Saturday, 10th April, 11am, in St. Agatha's Church.
FIRST HOLY COMMUNION:
All First Holy Communion ceremonies will take place at 11am.
Gaelscoil: Saturday 8th May in St. Patrick's.
St. Francis N.S.: Saturday 15th May in St. Agatha's.
Scoil Aodh Rua agus Nuala: Saturday 22nd May in St. Patrick's. If parents haven't already received one, application and enrolment forms for the sacraments of First Communion & Confirmation are now available from the Parish Office. If you wish to have your child celebrate any of the two sacraments next year, the relevant enrolment form must be completed. Completed forms (and if necessary, Baptismal Certs) have to be returned to the Parish Centre before Monday 2nd November.

Sunday Collections – Sunday 18th October
St. Patrick's Church: €1,465
St. Agatha's Church: € 920

Thank you for your contribution to the parish.

You can also use your card or phone to '*Tap to Donate*' in Donegal Church, to make your contributions and donations to St. Patrick's Church.